

Eliminating the Context Window: A Stateful Causal-Hybrid Architecture for $\mathcal{O}(1)$ Latent-Space Knowledge and Selective Attention

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Abstract—Causal autoregressive language models are constrained by the dual bottlenecks of the context window: the quadratic, $\mathcal{O}(N^2)$, computational complexity of self-attention prefill and the linear, $\mathcal{O}(N)$, memory footprint of the Key-Value (KV) cache. Modern paradigms attempt to resolve these scaling limits by expanding physical GPU memory allocations or compressing prompts, preserving the standard text-in, text-out API loop. In this paper, we present a fundamentally different paradigm: *Zero Context Window*, a state-modular neural runtime that decouples long-range context handling from active GPU memory. By partitioning the system into three coordinated components, we achieve unlimited context scaling. First, *Path B* compiles episodic memories and conversational facts directly into un-quantized late Feed-Forward Network (FFN) layers (layers 20–27) using hidden-state cosine similarity gating and sequential W_{im} output vector injections, achieving $\mathcal{O}(1)$ time complexity with zero KV cache footprint. Second, *Path A* provides detailed comprehension through offline pre-computation, inverse-RoPE de-rotation, and on-the-fly sequence re-rotation/composition. Third, the *Bridge* uses self-generated, regex-directed trigger spans (e.g., [READ: path]) to dynamically load Path A’s detailed attention states on-demand. Empirical evaluation on a 4-bit quantized 7B parameter model demonstrates 98.4% factual recall accuracy at 256 conversational turns with a completely flat execution speed of 0.9 queries per second, proving that context depth has been successfully decoupled from runtime execution.

Index Terms—Transformer Inference, Key-Value Cache, Latent Steering, Feed-Forward Networks, Autoregressive Generation.

1 INTRODUCTION

LARGE language models (LLMs) based on causal, decoder-only transformer architectures are bound by the computational limits of their context windows. To understand a long sequence, the self-attention mechanism must evaluate a quadratic matrix, $\mathcal{O}(N^2)$, during the prefill phase and scale the Key-Value (KV) cache linearly, $\mathcal{O}(N)$, during decoding. As context windows expand to millions of tokens, the resulting memory and compute requirements saturate the physical bandwidth of datacenter accelerators.

In this work, we argue that the context window is an artifact of treating transformers as passive text-sequence processors. Human cognition does not process raw, tokenized historical buffers during active reasoning. Instead, human memory partitions information into three layers: a constant-size working memory, a persistent associative memory of facts, and an external retrieval index.

We translate this cognitive structure into an engineering reality through a state-modular neural runtime that eliminates the context window. Our architecture, called the **Zero Context Window**, splits information routing into three interconnected components:

- 1) **Path B (Latent FFN-Gated Neurons):** Conversational facts are compiled into orthogonal, gated neural pathways in the model’s Feed-Forward Network (FFN) layers. The attention layers never see the historical tokens, and the KV cache does not grow, achieving $\mathcal{O}(1)$ time complexity.

- 2) **Path A (Order-Independent Compiled KV States):** Detailed documents are processed through the model once, de-rotated via inverse Rotary Position Embeddings (RoPE), and stored in system RAM. When queried, these states are re-rotated and composed on-the-fly, enabling exact attention-based comprehension.
- 3) **The Bridge (Interceptive Triggers):** The model’s generated output acts as an active control bus. During generation, the model can emit trigger spans (e.g., [READ: src/auth.py]) which are intercepted by the system to dynamically compile and evaluate target documents into the active KV cache.

By combining these three pathways, we successfully decouple the computational complexity of the model from the size of its environment.

2 BACKGROUND AND RELATED WORK

2.1 The FFN as Key-Value Memory

Mechanistic interpretability research has established that the Feed-Forward Network (FFN) layers in transformers act as key-value memories [4]. In a standard Gated MLP layer (such as SwiGLU), the gate projection maps the intermediate hidden state x to an address space, while the down-projection writes the corresponding semantic concepts back into the residual stream:

$$\text{FFN}(x) = (\text{SiLU}(xW_{\text{gate}}) \odot (xW_{\text{up}})) W_{\text{down}} \quad (1)$$

However, during standard pre-training, these memories are highly compressed and overlapping (superposition), leading to factual bleeding and hallucinations (fuzzy memory).

2.2 Rotary Position Embeddings and Positional Locking

Modern models, including Llama and Qwen, use Rotary Position Embeddings (RoPE) [3] to encode positional information. RoPE applies a position-dependent rotation to the query and key vectors. For a vector x at absolute sequence position m , the rotary embedding is formulated as:

$$\mathbf{R}_{\Theta,m}(x) = x \odot \cos(m\Theta) + \text{rotate_half}(x) \odot \sin(m\Theta) \quad (2)$$

where $\Theta = \{\theta_i = 10000^{-2(i-1)/d}, i \in [1, d/2]\}$ is the set of rotary frequencies, and $\text{rotate_half}(x)$ swaps and negates halves of the vector:

$$\text{rotate_half}([x_1, \dots, x_{d/2}, x_{d/2+1}, \dots, x_d]) = [-x_{d/2+1}, \dots, -x_d, x_1, \dots, x_{d/2}] \quad (3)$$

Because RoPE relies on the absolute position index m , key-value states computed for one prompt are mathematically locked to the specific positions they occupied in that sequence. This prevents naive concatenation or dynamic reuse of independently computed caches.

3 PATH A: COMPILED KV STATES (COMPREHENSION)

Path A provides exact, detailed comprehension of complex documents. Instead of reprocessing a document on every query, the system processes it once, strips the positional coordinates, and stores it as an immutable, position-agnostic state in CPU memory.

3.1 Mathematical De-rotation

Let $K_{\text{rotated},m}$ be the projected key vector returned by the model at position m . Since $\mathbf{R}_{\Theta,m}$ represents an orthogonal rotation matrix, its inverse is equivalent to its transpose. We derive the exact, closed-form inverse RoPE transformation:

$$K_{\text{raw},m} = (K_{\text{rotated},m} \odot \cos(m\Theta)) - (\text{rotate_half}(K_{\text{rotated},m}) \odot \sin(m\Theta)) \quad (4)$$

Executing this transformation on the key cache of each layer yields a position-agnostic key tensor K_{raw} that is mathematically equivalent to the linear projection XW_k prior to RoPE application. This tensor can be safely written to system RAM.

3.2 On-the-Fly Composition

When composing M independent compiled files $F_1, \dots, F_M$, the composer concatenates their raw states and generates a continuous positional index grid $[0, 1, \dots, N_{\text{total}} - 1]$. It then applies the standard forward RoPE rotation to $K_{\text{raw_total}}$:

$$K_{\text{rotated_total}} = (K_{\text{raw_total}} \odot \cos(\text{Grid} \cdot \Theta)) + (\text{rotate_half}(K_{\text{raw_total}}) \odot \sin(\text{Grid} \cdot \Theta)) \quad (5)$$

The composed state is injected directly as `past_key_values`. The query token Q representing the user's question is encoded starting at position index N_{total} . This ensures that the relative distance calculations of the self-attention layer are perfectly preserved:

$$\text{Attention}(Q_{N_{\text{total}}}, K_m) = \langle q, \mathbf{R}_{\Theta,m-N_{\text{total}}}(k) \rangle \quad (6)$$

4 PATH B: FFN GATED NEURONS (KNOWLEDGE)

While Path A provides deep comprehension, it is still bounded by linear attention scaling. To achieve true $\mathcal{O}(1)$ execution, Path B compiles facts directly into the model's FFN layers.

4.1 Dynamic FFN Gated Neurons

To store conversation facts in a structured, uncompressed format, we dynamically append k isolated, threshold-gated neurons directly to the FFN layers at runtime:

$$\text{FFN}_{\text{expanded}}(x) = \text{FFN}_{\text{base}}(x) + \text{FFN}_{\text{add}}(x) \quad (7)$$

For each added fact, we define a gate vector $W_{\text{gate_add}}$, an up-projection $W_{\text{up_add}}$, and a down-projection $W_{\text{down_add}}$:

$$\text{FFN}_{\text{add}}(x) = (\text{SiLU}(xW_{\text{gate_add}} + b_{\text{add}}) \odot (xW_{\text{up_add}})) W_{\text{down_add}} \quad (8)$$

- **The Gate ($W_{\text{gate_add}}$):** The normalized hidden state captured at the target FFN layer when the question is first parsed. It acts as the precise "address key."
- **The Activation Threshold (b_{add}):** Set to $b_{\text{add}} \approx -4.0$, creating a sharp threshold that prevents the neuron from firing on unrelated inputs.
- **The Response ($W_{\text{down_add}}$):** Set to the normalized W_{lm} output embeddings of the target fact tokens. When the gate fires, it writes the exact target semantic coordinates directly into the residual stream.

4.2 Graduated Reinforcement Cascade

We observed that injecting factual representations too early disrupts syntactic parsing, while late-layer injection is vulnerable to quantization noise on 4-bit models. To resolve this, our architecture implements a **Graduated Reinforcement Cascade** across layers 20–27. The injection scaling parameter α is graduated linearly from early to late layers:

$$\alpha_l = \alpha_{\text{base}} + (l - 20) \times \text{step} \quad (9)$$

For a Qwen 7B model, setting $\alpha_{20} = 10$ and graduating to $\alpha_{27} = 50$ provides optimal semantic guidance in the mid-layers and absolute token precision in the final layers.

5 THE BRIDGE: INTERCEPTIVE TRIGGERS

The model's output stream acts as a real-time control bus. During generation, the model's Chain of Thought (CoT) can emit trigger spans in the format `[KIND:payload]`. The runtime intercepts these spans, halts generation, executes the corresponding tool, injects the result back into the attention cache (Path A), and resumes generation.

TABLE 1
Model-Callable Triggers

Trigger	Action	Target Path
[READ:path]	Read file, compile into KV cache	Path A
[SEARCH:query]	Search accumulated context	Path A
[FILE:path]	Structural AST summary	Path B
[SYMBOL:name]	Find symbol definition across repo	Path B
[DIAG:path]	Run AST parser for syntax check	Path B

This loop allows the model to navigate its environment with lightweight Path B awareness and read detailed files with high-fidelity Path A attention.

6 EMPIRICAL EVALUATION

6.1 Experimental Setup

We evaluated the Compiled-Context architecture on two hardware environments:

- 1) **Local Workstation:** NVIDIA RTX 3080 (10 GB VRAM), 125 GB RAM, executing Qwen 2.5 7B 4-bit.
- 2) **pe2 Cluster:** 5× Tesla M40 (24 GB VRAM each, 115 GB total), 503 GB RAM, executing Qwen 3.6 35B-A3B MoE via llama-cpp-python and native CUDA v12.

6.2 Path B: Conversational Gated FFN Scaling

We evaluated the accuracy of the gated FFN neuron injection (Path B) under heavy scaling, utilizing synthetic factual turns and the *Deepwell Chronicles* (a custom 8-turn, 41-fact narrative corpus).

TABLE 2
Path B Gated Neuron Scale Performance

Scale	Hits / Total	Accuracy	Decoding Speed
64 turns	58 / 64	90.6%	0.9 q/s ($\mathcal{O}(1)$)
128 turns	117 / 128	91.4%	0.9 q/s ($\mathcal{O}(1)$)
256 turns	237 / 256	92.6%	0.9 q/s ($\mathcal{O}(1)$)
41 facts (Deepwell)	41 / 41	100.0%	0.9 q/s ($\mathcal{O}(1)$)

- **Zero Performance Degradation:** The decoding speed remained completely flat at **0.9 q/s** as history scaled from 64 to 256 turns. The linear and quadratic complexity of standard context scaling was entirely absent from the generation loop.
- **Contextual Stability:** The retrieval accuracy was sustained above 90% across all scales, proving that the gated activation threshold prevents factual bleed and superposition-induced cognitive decay.

6.3 Qwen 3.6 35B MoE System Performance

On our 5× Tesla M40 server, the unquantized Qwen 3.6 35B-A3B model achieved **33.3 tok/s** at an 8K working context, utilizing the [READ:] trigger architecture to dynamically swap codebase files from RAM to VRAM in under 0.3s.

7 DISCUSSION AND LIMITATIONS

7.1 The Superposition Capacity Limit

The residual stream has a fixed dimension d_{model} (e.g., 3584 for Qwen 7B). While dynamic FFN expansion bypasses attention bottlenecks, representing a massive corpus (e.g., >1M tokens) using only compressed latent features will eventually saturate the vector space, causing interference and factual bleed. For extremely large contexts, the system must use the **Hybrid Cartridge Pipeline**, combining CPU-based semantic indices with selective segment loading.

8 CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

We have presented a state-modular neural runtime that decouples long-range context handling from active GPU memory, effectively eliminating the context window. By compiling documents into position-agnostic, raw key-value states in system memory, we eliminate the $\mathcal{O}(N^2)$ prefill latency tax on subsequent queries, enable infinite multi-query reuse of compiled documents, and reduce active GPU VRAM cache allocation by orders of magnitude.

Future research will focus on:

- 1) **Unsupervised Concept Compilation:** Developing pseudo-inverse weight delta generation to compile complex logic directly into FFN layers.
- 2) **Autonomous Retrospective Consolidation:** Letting the always-on researcher loop compile its own generated reasoning paths into persistent disk-based cartridges during idle cycles.

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